Assignment – Volunteer Management Action Plan (VMAP)

Introduction:

Once you have met with your Host Site Supervisor and completed the Initial Assessment Table and Initial Assessment Summary on the EVMP Worksheet, your next task is to create a Volunteer Management Action Plan (VMAP) to carry out a tangible action related to your volunteer program. Brainstorm some ideas about ways to improve your site's volunteer program. Talk with your Host Site Supervisor about ways to do this.

Some examples include:

- A volunteer event or series of volunteer events
- Recruiting x volunteers who will return on an ongoing basis
- Partnering with a local business or career center to provide meaningful volunteer experiences for their staff/participants
- A volunteer recognition event if the volunteer base is separated from the organization

This list is not exhaustive, but a series of examples that might work for your site. The purpose of this is for you to practice a tangible skill related to volunteer management, and we want this to be meaningful to you and your organization.

Assignment:

Complete the Volunteer Management Action Plan (VMAP) below. Please set up a time to speak with MCC Staff to go over your plan. During your term of service, it is expected that you will fulfil your Volunteer Management Action Plan. Adjusting your plan during the term is fine, check in with MCC staff if questions or extra support is needed.

- Come up with a tangible action to improve your volunteer program and fill out the VMAP form below
- Schedule a meeting with MCC Staff to go over your VMAP

Volunteer Management Action Plan (VMAP)

Step 1: Summarize the tangible outcome of your VMAP in as few words as possible.

I want to: Host a Family & Friends Volunteer Day at Hurricane Island. Through outreach for this, family and friends will understand better the mission of the island and being able to share with their connections throughout the US widely.

Step 2: Make your plan detailed and SPECIFIC.
Answer who/what/where/how/when.

Who: invite family and friends of staff members on the island. Utilize the help of the advancement team on Hurricane to make flyers and for outreach.

What: Host a volunteer day on the island with staff friends and family. Put volunteers into groups volunteering with things part of their interests.

Where: Hurricane Island Center for Science and Leadership. Ferry from Rockland→ Vinalhaven, then pick up with boat.

How: Work with Crickett, the island operations director, to find a good weekend to host volunteers (probably will be in the fall). Create a flyer with the relevant details, with help from Cam and Danielle in advancement. Send the flyer to staff requesting that they send it to their friends and family, inviting them to participate in the volunteer day. Work with Crickett and the other heads of operations (Captains, Facilities, Galley, Education) to design volunteer activities for the day. Also plan logistics of getting to the island with Captains and operations.

When: likely in the fall, after the busy summer

Step 3: Make your idea MEASURABLE. Add details, measurements and tracking details.

I will measure/track my VMAP by using the following methods:

Make sure to send the flyer to 26 year-round and full-season staff (plus 9 summer staff(?)). Track interest and sign ups with Google Form survey.

I will know I've accomplished my VMAP when:

When we have a successful volunteer day on the island with staff friends and family! My goal is to aim for 15 volunteers or more.

Step 4: Make your idea ATTAINABLE. What additional resources do you need for success?

Items I need to accomplish my VMAP:

Meetings/ chats scheduled with Crickett, heads of the different operations, advancement team.

How I'll find the time:

I can work on this while the students have free time during programming and on days students arrive later or depart earlier and there is a free morning/afternoon.

Things I need to learn more about:

How volunteer days typically run at Hurricane; if there might be a direct boat from Rockland (rather than having people take the ferry).

People I can talk to for support:

The advancement team, Crickett (head of island operations); Rachel (head of the galley and very involved and passionate about volunteer activities); MCC staff.

Step 5: Make your plan RELEVANT/REALISTIC : List why you want to complete this action plan and impact of expected result.

I want to complete this action because I want to make the island feel more accessible to more people. I want to share with friends and family the mission of Hurricane and invite them to come out and see it for themselves. I think this is a great way to spread awareness and understanding, even if some friends and family aren't able to make it that specific day – they know more about Hurricane Island. I expect the word to spread beyond Maine and the Northeast coast as many staff are from different states.

Step 6: Make your plan TIMELY. Put a deadline on your VMAP and set some benchmarks.

How will you accomplish this VMAP? List at least 3 actions steps you'll take (be specific):

1. Have conversations. Speak with the heads of operations about volunteer activities to get a sense of what they would like help with and so I can be specific in outreach. Speak with Crickett about a good date to set. Speak with the advancement team about how this aligns with their initiatives and what resources they can provide.
   Deadline: June 5

2. Brainstorm and begin creation of materials – survey sent out to staff to gauge interest from their friends and family and an possible initial head count. Begin creating the flyer with relevant details (date, time, logistics, fun activities!).
   Deadline: June 12

3. Send out flyer to friends and family and establish a check-in with staff to encourage them to send it around to their friends, family, loved ones.
   Deadline: June 30 (by the end of June ideally so folks can begin planning)

I will complete my VMAP by (date): October 1st

My halfway measurement will be Having the informational flyer done and the survey on interest and potential head count numbers filled out by all staff and received. on JUNE 19.

Additional dates and milestone I'll aim for: By the end of June, early July, have the flyer sent out. Send another reminder in mid-August about it.

Step 7: Set up a time to check in with MCC Staff (face to face, phone, skype) to discuss this action plan. List any questions you have for MCC Staff:

No questions right now

Additional Notes:

Click or tap here to enter text.